

GRAPH TRAVERSAL

GRAPH TRAVERSAL ALGORITHMS

There are two standard methods of graph traversal .

1. Breadth-first search

2. Depth-first search

- ❖ breadth-first search uses a **queue** as an auxiliary data structure to store nodes for further processing,
- ❖ depth-first search scheme uses a **stack**.
- ❖ Both these algorithms make use of a variable **STATUS**.

During the execution of the algorithm, every node in the graph will have the variable STATUS set to 1, 2 or 3, depending on its current state.

Status	State of the node	Description
1	Ready	The initial state of the node N
2	Waiting	Node N is placed on the queue or stack and waiting to be processed
3	Processed	Node N has been completely processed

Breadth-First Search

Breadth-first search (BFS) is a graph search algorithm

- ❑ that begins at the root node and explores all the neighboring nodes.
- ❑ Then for each of those nearest nodes, the algorithm explores their unexplored neighbor nodes, and so on, until it finds the goal.

Steps

1. We start examining the node A and then all the neighbors of A are examined.
2. Next, we examine the neighbors of neighbors of A, so on and so forth.

This means that we need to track the neighbors of the node and guarantee that every node in the graph is processed and no node is processed more than once. This is **accomplished by using a queue** that will hold the nodes that are waiting for further processing and a variable STATUS to represent the current state of the node.

Breadth-First Search Algorithm

- Step 1: SET STATUS = 1 (ready state)
for each node in G
- Step 2: Enqueue the starting node A
and set its STATUS = 2
(waiting state)
- Step 3: Repeat Steps 4 and 5 until
QUEUE is empty
- Step 4: Dequeue a node N. Process it
and set its STATUS = 3
(processed state).
- Step 5: Enqueue all the neighbours of
N that are in the ready state
(whose STATUS = 1) and set
their STATUS = 2
(waiting state)
[END OF LOOP]
- Step 6: EXIT

Consider the graph G given in Figure

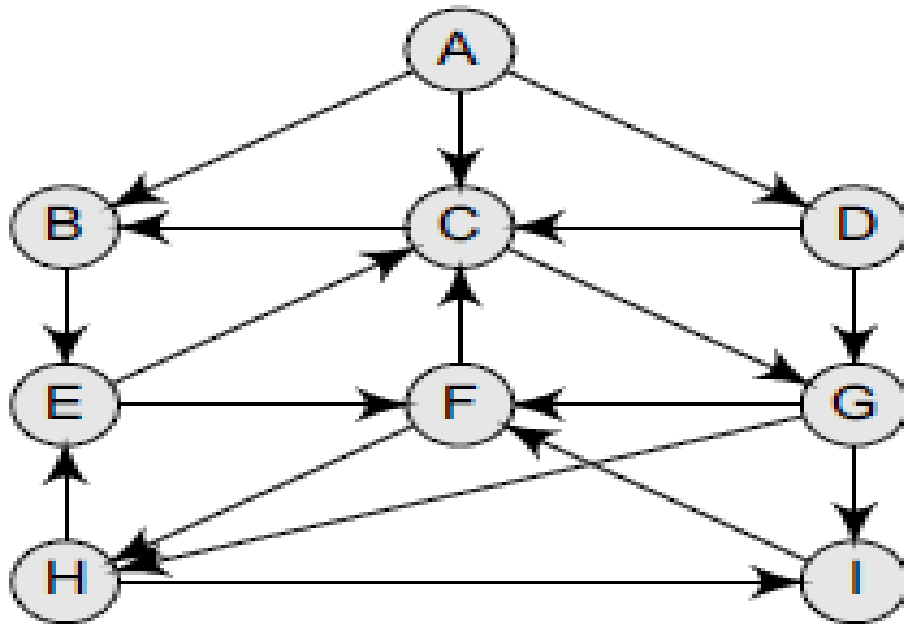
The adjacency list of G is also given.

Assume that

→ G represents the daily flights between different cities

→ we want to fly from city A to I with minimum stops.

find the minimum path P from A to I given that every edge has a length of 1.



Adjacency lists

A: B, C, D

B: E

C: B, G

D: C, G

E: C, F

F: C, H

G: F, H, I

H: E, I

I: F

(a) Add A to QUEUE and add NULL to ORIG.

FRONT = 0	QUEUE = A
REAR = 0	ORIG = \0

(b) Dequeue a node by setting $\text{FRONT} = \text{FRONT} + 1$ (remove the FRONT element of QUEUE) and enqueue the neighbours of A. Also, add A as the ORIG of its neighbours.

FRONT = 1	QUEUE = A	B	C	D
REAR = 3	ORIG = \0	A	A	A

(c) Dequeue a node by setting $\text{FRONT} = \text{FRONT} + 1$ and enqueue the neighbours of B. Also, add B as the ORIG of its neighbours.

FRONT = 2	QUEUE = A	B	C	D	E
REAR = 4	ORIG = \0	A	A	A	B

(d) Dequeue a node by setting $\text{FRONT} = \text{FRONT} + 1$ and enqueue the neighbours of c. Also, add c as the ORIG of its neighbours. Note that c has two neighbours B and G. Since B has already been added to the queue and it is not in the Ready state, we will not add B and only add G.

FRONT = 3	QUEUE = A	B	C	D	E	G
REAR = 5	ORIG = \0	A	A	A	B	C

Adjacency lists

A: B, C, D
 B: E
 C: B, G
 D: C, G
 E: C, F
 F: C, H
 G: F, H, I
 H: E, I
 I: F

- (e) Dequeue a node by setting $FRONT = FRONT + 1$ and enqueue the neighbours of D. Also, add D as the ORIG of its neighbours. Note that D has two neighbours C and G. Since both of them have already been added to the queue and they are not in the Ready state, we will not add them again.

FRONT = 4	QUEUE =	A	B	C	D	E	G
REAR = 5	ORIG =	\0	A	A	A	B	C

- (f) Dequeue a node by setting $FRONT = FRONT + 1$ and enqueue the neighbours of E. Also, add E as the ORIG of its neighbours. Note that E has two neighbours C and F. Since C has already been added to the queue and it is not in the Ready state, we will not add C and add only F.

FRONT = 5	QUEUE =	A	B	C	D	E	G	F
REAR = 6	ORIG =	\0	A	A	A	B	C	E

- (g) Dequeue a node by setting $FRONT = FRONT + 1$ and enqueue the neighbours of G. Also, add G as the ORIG of its neighbours. Note that G has three neighbours F, H, and I.

FRONT = 6	QUEUE =	A	B	C	D	E	G	F	H	I
REAR = 9	ORIG =	\0	A	A	A	B	C	E	G	G

Since F has already been added to the queue, we will only add H and I. As I is our final destination, we stop the execution of this algorithm as soon as it is encountered and added to the QUEUE. Now, backtrack from I using ORIG to find the minimum path P. Thus, we have P as $A \rightarrow C \rightarrow G \rightarrow I$.

Adjacency lists

A: B, C, D

B: E

C: B, G

D: C, G

E: C, F

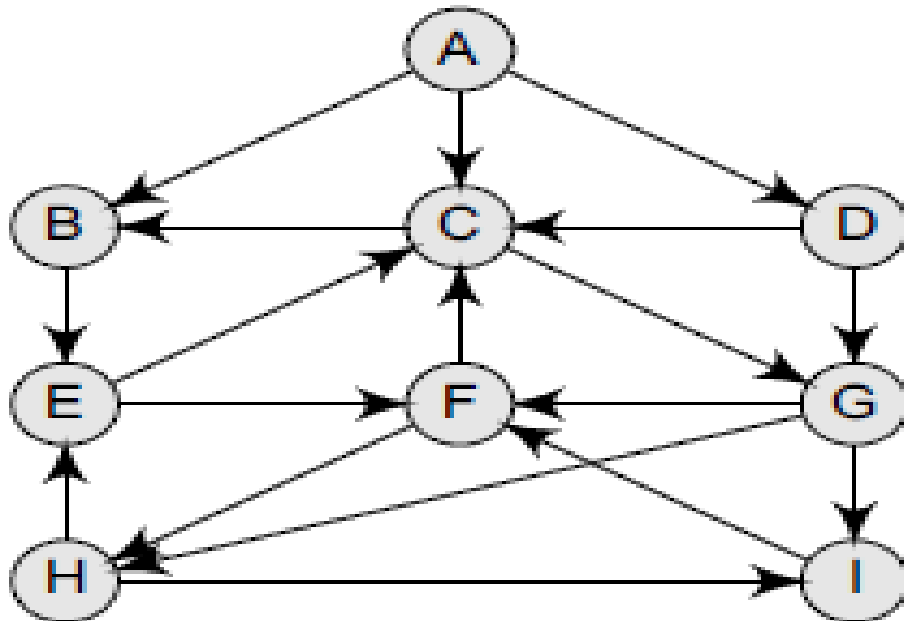
F: C, H

G: F, H, I

H: E, I

I: F

Find the order of execution of nodes in BFS



Adjacency lists

A: B, C, D

B: E

C: B, G

D: C, G

E: C, F

F: C, H

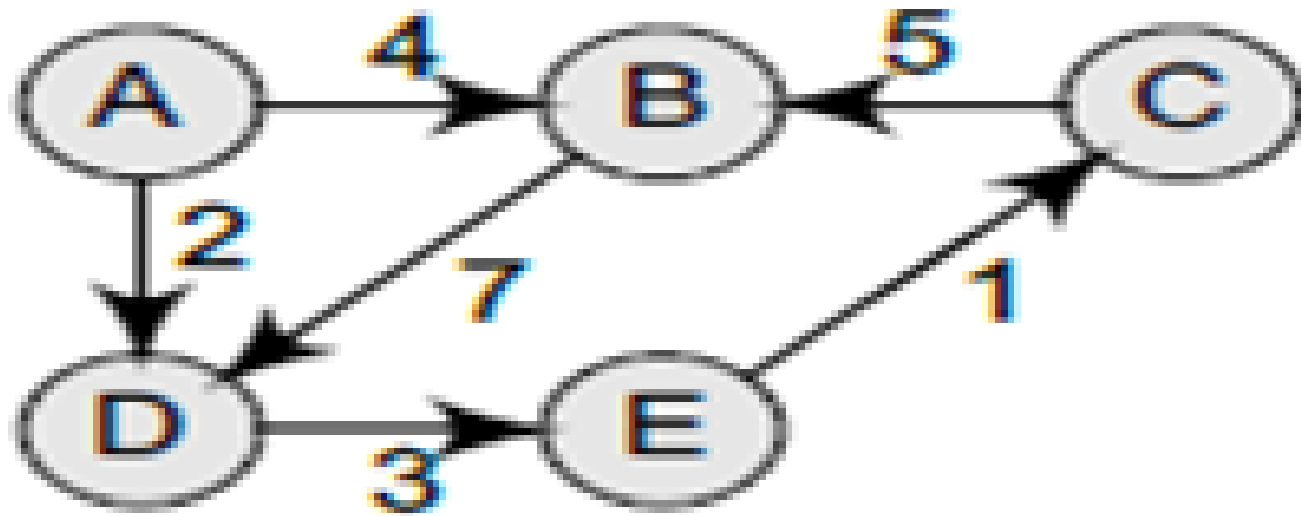
G: F, H, I

H: E, I

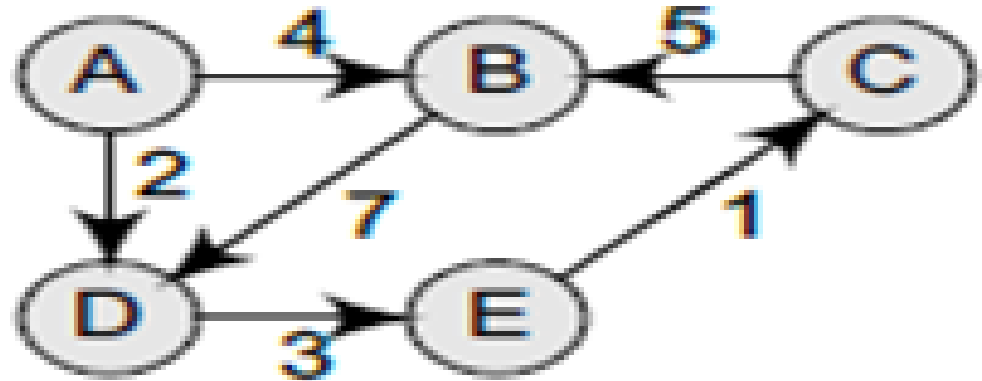
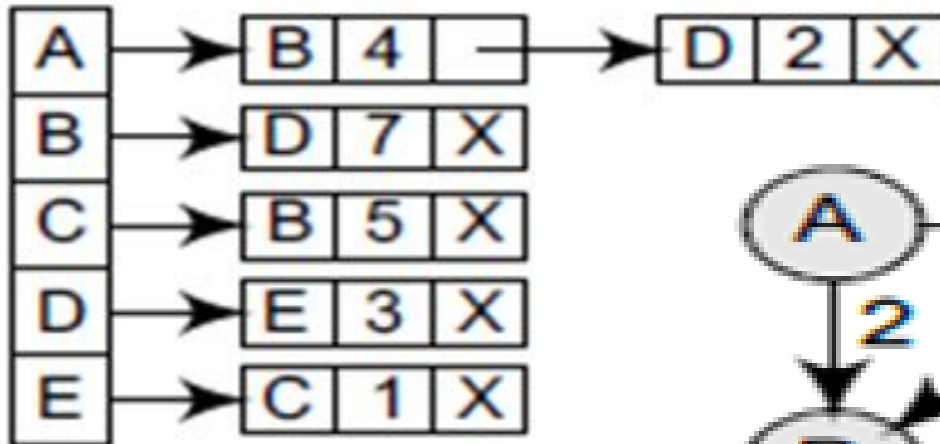
I: F

A B C D E G F H I

Find the path from A to C



Find the path from A to C



Index	0	1	2	3	4
Vertex	A	B	D	E	C
Pred.	/0	A	A	D	E
STA=2	2	2	2	2	2
STA=3	3	3	3	3	
Front	0	1	2	3	4
Rear	0	2	2	3	4

A -> D -> E -> C

$$2 + 3 + 1 = 6$$

Applications of Breadth-First Search Algorithm

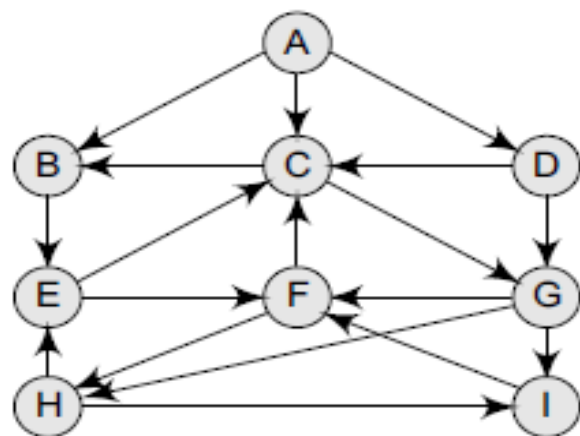
Breadth-first search can be used to solve many problems such as:

1. Finding all connected components in a graph G .
2. Finding the shortest between two nodes, u and v , of an unweighted graph.

Depth-First Search

Depth-first Search Algorithm

- Step 1: SET STATUS = 1 (ready state) for each node in G
 - Step 2: Push the starting node A on the stack and set its STATUS = 2 (waiting state)
 - Step 3: Repeat Steps 4 and 5 until STACK is empty
 - Step 4: Pop the top node N. Process it and set its STATUS = 3 (processed state)
 - Step 5: Push on the stack all the neighbours of N that are in the ready state (whose STATUS = 1) and set their STATUS = 2 (waiting state)
 - [END OF LOOP]
 - Step 6: EXIT
-



Adjacency lists

A: B, C, D
 B: E
 C: B, G
 D: C, G
 E: C, F
 F: C, H
 G: F, H, I
 H: E, I
 I: F

(a) Push H onto the stack.

STACK: H

(b) Pop and print the top element of the STACK, that is, H. Push all the neighbours of H onto the stack that are in the ready state. The STACK now becomes

PRINT: H

STACK: E, I

(c) Pop and print the top element of the STACK, that is, I. Push all the neighbours of I onto the stack that are in the ready state. The STACK now becomes

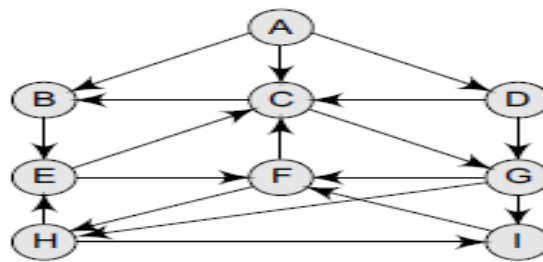
PRINT: I

STACK: E, F

(d) Pop and print the top element of the STACK, that is, F. Push all the neighbours of F onto the stack that are in the ready state. (Note F has two neighbours, C and H. But only C will be added, as H is not in the ready state.) The STACK now becomes

PRINT: F

STACK: E, C



Adjacency lists

A: B, C, D

B: E

C: B, G

D: C, G

E: C, F

F: C, H

G: F, H, I

H: E, I

I: F

- (e) Pop and print the top element of the *STACK*, that is, c. Push all the neighbours of c onto the stack that are in the ready state. The *STACK* now becomes

PRINT: C

STACK: E, B, G

- (f) Pop and print the top element of the *STACK*, that is, g. Push all the neighbours of g onto the stack that are in the ready state. Since there are no neighbours of g that are in the ready state, no push operation is performed. The *STACK* now becomes

PRINT: G

STACK: E, B

- (g) Pop and print the top element of the *STACK*, that is, b. Push all the neighbours of b onto the stack that are in the ready state. Since there are no neighbours of b that are in the ready state, no push operation is performed. The *STACK* now becomes

PRINT: B

STACK: E

- (h) Pop and print the top element of the *STACK*, that is, e. Push all the neighbours of e onto the stack that are in the ready state. Since there are no neighbours of e that are in the ready state, no push operation is performed. The *STACK* now becomes empty.

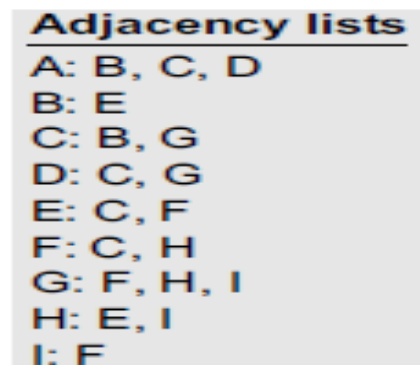
PRINT: E

STACK:

Since the *STACK* is now empty, the depth-first search of G starting at node H is complete and the nodes which were printed are:

H, I, F, C, G, B, E

These are the nodes which are reachable from the node H.



H, I, F, C, G, B, E

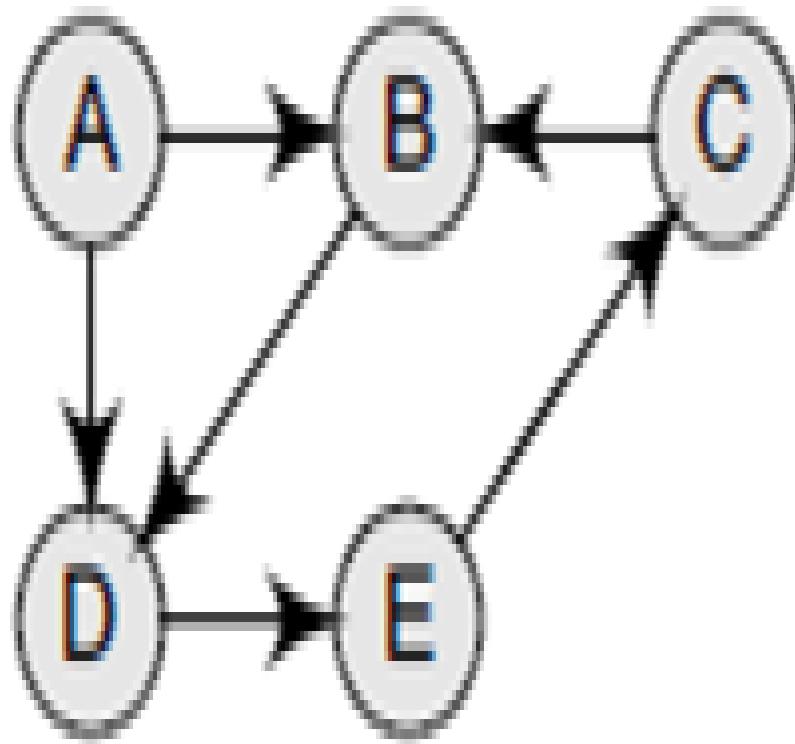
Vertex	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I
STA-1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
STA-2		2	2		2	2	2	2	2
STA-3		3	3		3	3	3	3	3

Applications of Depth-First Search Algorithm

Depth-first search is useful for:

1. Finding a path between two specified nodes, u and v , of an unweighted and weighted graph.
2. Finding whether any vertex is reachable or not.
3. Computing the spanning tree of a connected graph.

Use BFS and DFS to traverse the graph



Use BFS and DFS to traverse the graph

